10 years, but it's still in development.

Red Hat has its whole middleware division based on Java. We are the No. 2 community of JDK. Also, we are supporting OpenJDK and driving a lot of standards around Java EE, as well as steering the Java Community Process and working on all the key JPAs.

Ploski: We at Red Hat brought out a project called Hibernate that pushed Java Community Process and JPA standards. There are only three major application services —JBoss is one of them and it is growing rapidly with Java power. Likewise, we were the first to certify Java EE Server after Glassfish.

Additionally, we are impacting not only the JVM and Java specifications, but also the other languages that run on top of JVM.

Q How do cloud computing and open source go hand-in-hand?

Ploski: There is a new paradigm for the actual deployment of open source on the cloud. Red Hat calls it the open hybrid cloud. We've invested decades in data centre type of technology and the evolution of virtualisation. The cloud could be defined as both the private and public clouds. But, of course, there is not one size that fits all. You will have some clients that will never put their entire data on a public cloud. So you need to find out how you can resolve that problem by deploying an open source solution. You can pick options like OpenStack and standards to suit the need. In this way, you can use open source with a cloud.

Q What are Red Hat's solutions for startups?

Ploski: We have a program called Red Hat Connect for Technology Partners. It helps startups and SMEs utilise open source solutions with ease. There are three big segments in open source deployment — 10 per cent are academics or contributors, 40 per cent are businesses and 50 per cent are startups and independent software vendors. So Red Hat Connect is the area that offers a path to not only developers but also to enterprises and startups.

Apart from Red Hat Connect, entrepreneurs can join the Red Hat Developers Program and gain knowledge through Red Hat's developer site. We also offer Red Hat Enterprise Linux to enterprises in India to help them expand their operations with the open source platform.

Q How is open source aligning with IoT?

Ploski: It's been great for Red Hat to align open source with the Internet of Things (IoT). Our president and CEO, Jim Whitehurst, has already begun the process of bringing open source closer to IoT. Open source makes IoT developments faster as you can fix bugs in your program before providing them with connected devices. Also, the security aspects of Red Hat will enhance the growing space of IoT.

McWhirter: IoT is a pretty broad spectrum. You have edge devices that continually stream data and the signal-to-noise ratio is not necessarily something that hits directly to a cloud. We are developing solutions particularly for gateways and not for edge devices. We work on gateway devices and provide one of the most secured solutions, which is even more secure than a closed source solution.

Ploski: Some combat zones use a mix and match of open source and IoT right in the battlefield, to let machines communicate with each other and exchange secret information.

McWhirter: Red Hat has an official group within its core team that works on IoT developments. It's an extension of our business that has been around for a very long time. IoT brings a lot of different protocols and packet styles that we adjust using our own methods. END